BUSFIN 8200: Problem Set 2

Xi Wang

October 25, 2026

Question 1

(a)

We have complete markets iff we can find a unique matrix Ω s.t. $X\Omega = I$, where

$$X = \begin{bmatrix} 10 & 10 & 0 \\ 20 & 10 & 10 \\ 30 & 10 & 10 \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \Omega = \begin{bmatrix} | & | & | \\ w_1 & w_2 & w_3 \\ | & | & | \end{bmatrix},$$

and each w_i is a portfolio weight vector using A, B and C. For example, $(10, 20, 30)'$ is asset A's payoff across the three states.

$X\Omega = I$ means

$$Xw_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad Xw_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad Xw_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Because X is 3×3, $X\Omega = I$ has a unique solution iff X is invertible, and

$$X \text{ invertible} \iff \det(X) \neq 0 \iff \operatorname{rank}(X) = 3.$$

$$X = \begin{bmatrix} 10 & 10 & 0 \\ 20 & 10 & 10 \\ 30 & 10 & 10 \end{bmatrix} = 10 \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Row reduction:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{row } 3 - \text{row } 2: &\quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ \text{exchange rows 1 and 2}: &\quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ \text{row } 2 - \text{row } 1: &\quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \\ \text{row } 3 - 3 \cdot \text{row } 1 - \text{row } 2: &\quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Thus $\operatorname{rank}(X) = 3$ and X is invertible. $\Omega = X^{-1}$ exists and is unique, with $X\Omega = XX^{-1} = I$. Thus, the market is complete.

(b)

Let X be the matrix of $N = 3$ non-redundant asset payoffs, let P be the price vector of the original assets, and let $P_c = (q_1, q_2, q_3)'$ be the price vector of the contingent claims. Use the LOP to solve for P_c as a function of X and P:

$$P = \begin{pmatrix} 16 \\ 8 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad X = \begin{bmatrix} 10 & 10 & 0 \\ 20 & 10 & 10 \\ 30 & 10 & 10 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The LOP says that two assets with identical payoffs in every state of nature must have the same price. Therefore,

$$X'P_c = P \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \begin{bmatrix} 10 & 20 & 30 \\ 10 & 10 & 10 \\ 0 & 10 & 10 \end{bmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} q_1 \\ q_2 \\ q_3 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 16 \\ 8 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Dividing everything by 10:

$$\begin{cases} q_1 + 2q_2 + 3q_3 = 1.6 \\ q_1 + q_2 + q_3 = 0.8 \\ q_2 + q_3 = 0.6 \end{cases} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \begin{cases} q_1 = 0.2 \\ q_2 = 0.4 \\ q_3 = 0.2 \end{cases}$$

Thus, $P_c = (0.2, 0.4, 0.2)'$.

(c)

$$P_D = \text{Payoff}(D) \cdot P_c = \begin{pmatrix} 30 & 20 & 10 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0.2 \\ 0.4 \\ 0.2 \end{pmatrix} = 6 + 8 + 2 = 16.$$

(d)

$$P(X) = E[MX] = \sum_{s=1}^{S} \pi(s) M(s) X(s).$$

Since $q_s = \pi(s)M(s)$, we have $M(s) = q_s/\pi(s)$. With

$$P_c = \begin{pmatrix} 0.2 \\ 0.4 \\ 0.2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \pi(s) = \begin{pmatrix} 1/4 \\ 1/2 \\ 1/4 \end{pmatrix} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad M(s) = \begin{pmatrix} 0.8 \\ 0.8 \\ 0.8 \end{pmatrix}.$$

By definition, no arbitrage means that

1. An asset with payoff ≥ 0 must have price ≥ 0.
2. An asset with payoff ≥ 0 and a chance for payoff > 0 must have price > 0.

We have $X \geq 0$, $\Pr(X > 0) > 0$, and $P(X) = E[MX] > 0$ (since $M > 0$). Thus, there is no arbitrage.

Moreover, $P(X) = E[MX] = 0.8\,E[X]$. The SDF stays constant across the three states, which implies it is risk-neutral.

(e)

$$\begin{aligned} P_D = E[MX_D] &= \sum_{s=1}^{S} \pi(s) M(s) X_D(s) \\ &= \tfrac{1}{4} \cdot 0.8 \cdot 30 + \tfrac{1}{2} \cdot 0.8 \cdot 20 + \tfrac{1}{4} \cdot 0.8 \cdot 10 \\ &= 6 + 8 + 2 = 16. \end{aligned}$$

This is the same as in Q1(c).

Question 2

(a)

I construct the unconditional linear SDF as

$$\hat{M}_t^* = \hat{a} - \hat{b}' x R_t,$$

where $\hat{b} = \hat{\Sigma}^{-1}\hat{\mu}$ and $\hat{a} = 1 + \hat{b}'\hat{\mu}$, imposing the normalization $E[M^*] = 1$.

Table 1 reports the estimated SDF coefficients. The estimated SDF satisfies the unconditional pricing conditions, with $\widehat{E}[\hat{M}^*] = 1$ and $\widehat{E}[\hat{M}^* x R_j] \approx 0$ for all 10 portfolios.

Figure 1 shows no clear monotonic relationship between the estimated b_j coefficients and book-to-market deciles. Instead, the coefficients fluctuate considerably across portfolios, with both positive and negative values.

This pattern arises because the coefficients are determined by both the expected excess returns and the covariance structure of the portfolios, as reflected in $\hat{b} = \hat{\Sigma}^{-1}\hat{\mu}$. Therefore, portfolios with higher average excess returns do not necessarily receive larger positive coefficients.

Table 1: Estimated BM SDF intercept and coefficients, rounded to four decimal places. Each $\hat{b}_j$ corresponds to BM decile j; estimation uses decimal monthly excess returns.

$\hat{a}$	$\hat{b}_1$	$\hat{b}_2$	$\hat{b}_3$	$\hat{b}_4$	$\hat{b}_5$	$\hat{b}_6$	$\hat{b}_7$	$\hat{b}_8$	$\hat{b}_9$	$\hat{b}_{10}$
1.0368	-1.5850	3.5503	0.7104	-3.1122	1.1837	2.9972	-5.2931	2.4722	2.8775	-1.1771

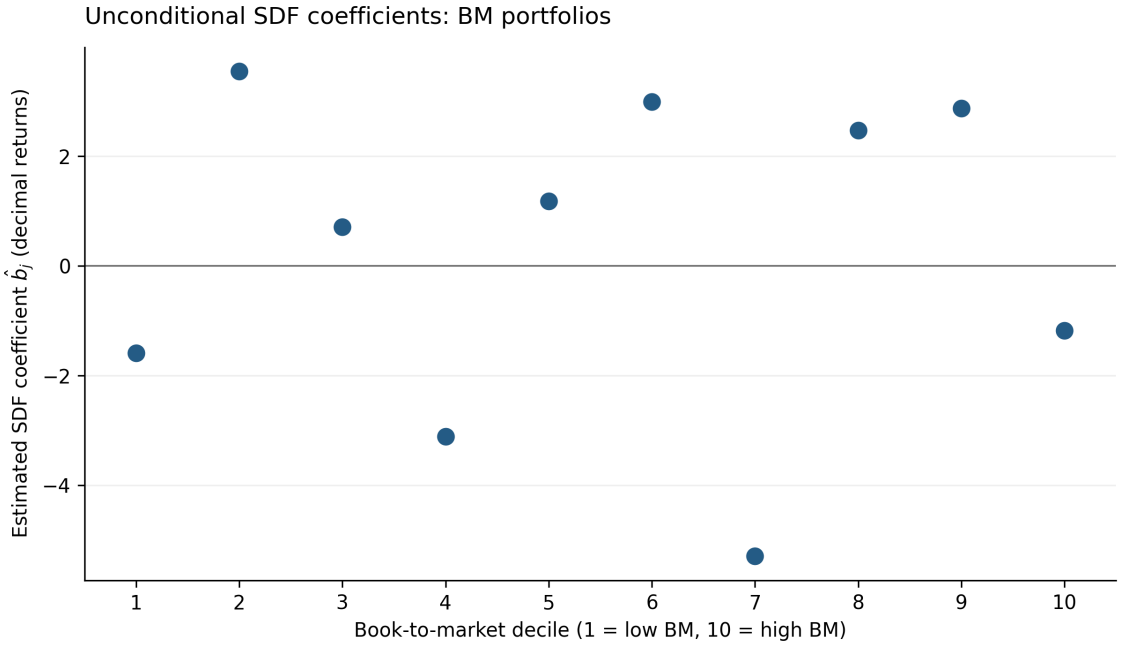


Figure 1: Estimated coefficients $\hat{b}_j$ in the unconditional SDF $\hat{M}_t^* = \hat{a} - \hat{b}' x R_t$, normalized so that $\widehat{E}[\hat{M}^*] = 1$. The sample contains 1,190 overlapping monthly observations from July 1927 through August 2026, as specified in the analysis prompt. Returns are in decimals, and the sample covariance matrix uses divisor T.

(b)

Following the same approach as in part (a), I construct the unconditional linear SDF using the 10 momentum portfolios. Table 2 reports the estimated SDF coefficients.

Figure 2 shows that the estimated coefficients vary considerably across momentum deciles, with both positive and negative values. There is no clear monotonic pattern. As in part (a), this pattern reflects both the expected excess returns and the covariance structure of the portfolios.

The sample correlation between the BM and MOM SDFs is 0.3555, indicating a moderate positive relationship. This suggests that the two SDFs capture some common variation, but also reflect different components of asset returns. The sample correlation between the BM and MOM SDFs is

$$\widehat{\mathrm{Corr}}\left(\hat{M}^{*,BM}, \hat{M}^{*,MOM}\right) = 0.3555.$$

This uses 1,190 aligned monthly observations from July 1927 through August 2026.

Table 2: Estimated MOM SDF intercept and coefficients, rounded to four decimal places. Each $\hat{b}_j$ corresponds to MOM decile j; estimation uses decimal monthly excess returns.

$\hat{a}$	$\hat{b}_1$	$\hat{b}_2$	$\hat{b}_3$	$\hat{b}_4$	$\hat{b}_5$	$\hat{b}_6$	$\hat{b}_7$	$\hat{b}_8$	$\hat{b}_9$	$\hat{b}_{10}$
1.0666	-4.0194	1.1429	0.1024	1.4897	2.5317	-0.8195	0.2777	0.9818	-0.9414	3.4370

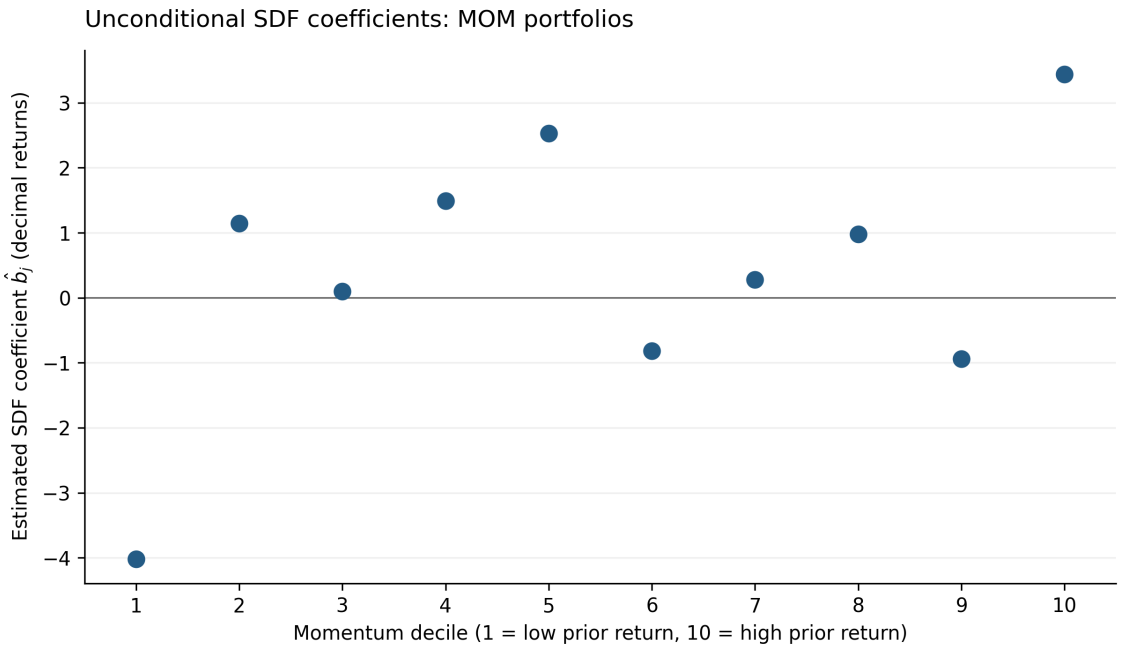


Figure 2: Estimated coefficients $\hat{b}_j$ in the unconditional SDF $\hat{M}_t^* = \hat{a} - \hat{b}' x R_t$ for the ten momentum portfolios, normalized so that $\widehat{E}[\hat{M}^*] = 1$. The sample contains 1,190 overlapping monthly observations from July 1927 through August 2026, as specified in the analysis prompt. Returns are in decimals, and the sample covariance matrix uses divisor T, as in part (a).

(c)

Following the same approach as in parts (a) and (b), I construct the unconditional linear SDF using the combined 20 BM and MOM portfolios. Table 3 reports the estimated SDF coefficients.

Figure 3 shows that the estimated coefficients vary considerably across both BM and MOM deciles, with positive and negative values and no clear monotonic pattern. Compared with parts (a) and (b), the coefficients change when the two sets of portfolios are combined, reflecting the additional covariance relationships and diversification opportunities.

Table 4 reports monthly Sharpe ratios of 0.1919, 0.2581, and 0.3045 for the BM, MOM, and combined maximum Sharpe ratio portfolios, respectively. The combined portfolio achieves the highest Sharpe ratio, consistent with the theoretical prediction that expanding the investment opportunity set cannot reduce the maximum attainable Sharpe ratio.

This result is also consistent with the SDF volatility bound discussed in class. Under the normalization $E[M^*] = 1$, the volatility of the constructed SDF equals the maximum Sharpe ratio. Thus, including both BM and MOM portfolios increases the maximum attainable Sharpe ratio and the volatility of the corresponding SDF.

Table 3: Combined SDF intercept and coefficients, rounded to four decimal places. The first ten coefficients correspond to BM portfolios and the next ten to MOM portfolios. Estimation uses decimal excess returns.

SDF intercept $\hat{a}$										1.0927
Decile j	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BM	-1.9664	2.4739	0.5781	-3.7439	1.0655	2.6840	-4.6456	2.4707	3.7398	-0.2415
MOM	-4.4169	0.6354	-0.1712	1.9480	1.4236	-0.8781	-0.1639	0.9802	-1.2708	3.4473

Table 4: Monthly Sharpe ratios of $xR_t^* = \hat{b}' xR_t$, using the same 1,190 months from July 1927 through August 2026. Variances use divisor T.

Portfolio set	Monthly Sharpe ratio
BM	0.1919
MOM	0.2581
Combined	0.3045

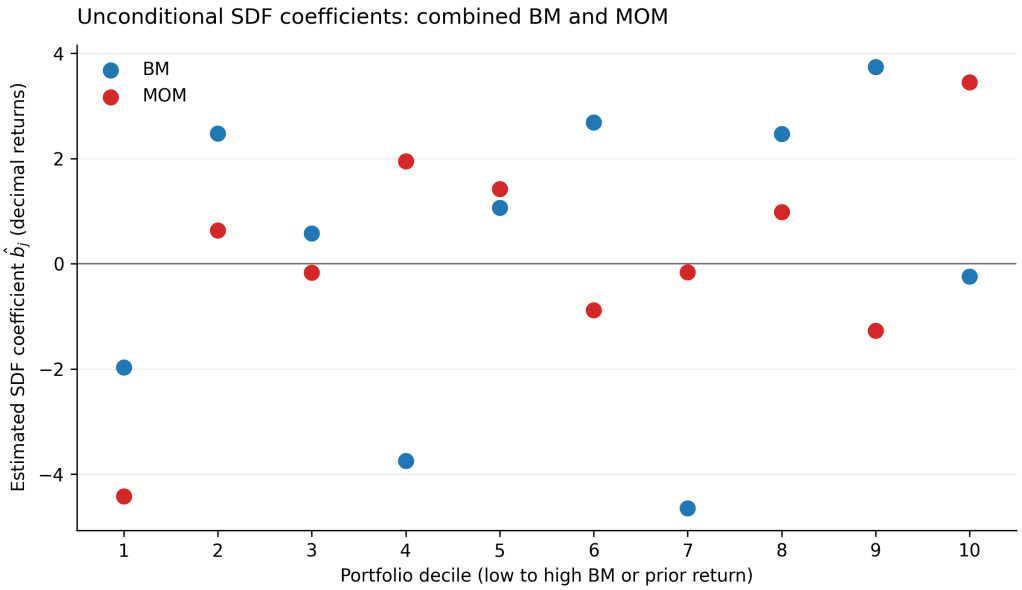


Figure 3: Coefficients in the combined BM–MOM SDF, normalized so that $\widehat{E}[\hat{M}^*] = 1$. Blue dots denote BM portfolios and red dots denote MOM portfolios. Returns are in decimals; the covariance matrix uses divisor T.

(d)

Table 5 reports the pricing errors of the 20 BM and MOM portfolios under the three SDFs constructed in parts (a), (b), and (c), using

$$\hat{\alpha}_p = \hat{E}[xR_p] - \widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(-\hat{M}^*, xR_p).$$

The pricing errors are essentially zero for the portfolios used to construct each SDF. Specifically, the BM SDF prices all 10 BM portfolios, the MOM SDF prices all 10 MOM portfolios, and the combined SDF prices all 20 portfolios, with errors close to numerical precision.

However, the BM and MOM SDFs exhibit nonzero pricing errors when applied to portfolios outside their respective construction sets. The maximum absolute pricing error is 0.010157 for MOM portfolios under the BM SDF, compared with 0.003450 for BM portfolios under the MOM SDF.

These results suggest that an SDF constructed from one set of portfolios does not necessarily price another set of portfolios accurately. The combined SDF eliminates the in-sample pricing errors by incorporating both sets of portfolios. However, this exact in-sample fit does not necessarily imply good out-of-sample pricing performance.

Table 5: Monthly pricing errors $\hat{\alpha}_p$ under the BM, MOM, and combined SDFs, in decimal return units and rounded to six decimal places. The common sample is July 1927 through August 2026 (1,190 months); covariances use divisor T.

Portfolio	BM SDF	MOM SDF	Combined SDF
BM: Lo 10	0.000000	-0.001511	0.000000
BM: 2-Dec	0.000000	-0.000101	0.000000
BM: 3-Dec	0.000000	-0.000223	0.000000
BM: 4-Dec	0.000000	-0.000778	0.000000
BM: 5-Dec	0.000000	0.000504	0.000000
BM: 6-Dec	0.000000	0.001261	0.000000
BM: 7-Dec	0.000000	0.000281	0.000000
BM: 8-Dec	0.000000	0.002376	0.000000
BM: 9-Dec	0.000000	0.003450	0.000000
BM: Hi 10	0.000000	0.003198	0.000000
MOM: Lo PRIOR	-0.010157	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 2	-0.005051	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 3	-0.003272	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 4	-0.001488	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 5	-0.000882	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 6	-0.000263	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 7	0.000509	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 8	0.001902	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: PRIOR 9	0.002240	0.000000	0.000000
MOM: Hi PRIOR	0.005418	0.000000	0.000000

(e)

Following Question 2(c), I re-estimate the SDF using monthly excess returns of the 20 BM and MOM decile portfolios from July 1927 through December 1989:

$$\hat{M}_t^* = \hat{a} - \hat{\mathbf{b}}' \mathbf{x}\mathbf{R}_t.$$

This gives the estimated intercept $\hat{a}$ and coefficient vector $\hat{\mathbf{b}}$.

I then hold the estimated coefficients fixed and construct the out-of-sample SDF using monthly excess returns from January 1990 through August 2026:

$$\hat{M}_{OS,t}^* = \hat{a} - \hat{\mathbf{b}}' \mathbf{x}\mathbf{R}_t.$$

For each of the 20 portfolios, I calculate the out-of-sample pricing error as

$$\hat{\alpha}_{OS,p} = \widehat{E}[xR_p] - \widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(-\hat{M}_{OS}^*, xR_p),$$

where both the expectation and covariance are estimated using only the out-of-sample observations. The resulting pricing errors are reported in Table 6. All 20 portfolios exhibit positive out-of-sample pricing errors, suggesting that the estimated SDF does not fully capture their average excess returns.

Table 6: Out-of-sample monthly pricing errors $\hat{\alpha}_{OS,p}$, in decimal return units and rounded to six decimal places. The SDF is estimated using July 1927 through December 1989 (750 months), with its intercept and coefficients held fixed for evaluation over January 1990 through August 2026 (440 months). Covariances use divisor T_{OS}.

Portfolio	Out-of-sample pricing error
BM: Lo 10	0.010971
BM: 2-Dec	0.007858
BM: 3-Dec	0.009002
BM: 4-Dec	0.006957
BM: 5-Dec	0.007986
BM: 6-Dec	0.007178
BM: 7-Dec	0.006977
BM: 8-Dec	0.005923
BM: 9-Dec	0.008269
BM: Hi 10	0.009709
MOM: Lo PRIOR	0.027055
MOM: PRIOR 2	0.016483
MOM: PRIOR 3	0.013905
MOM: PRIOR 4	0.012077
MOM: PRIOR 5	0.009180
MOM: PRIOR 6	0.008297
MOM: PRIOR 7	0.007601
MOM: PRIOR 8	0.006444
MOM: PRIOR 9	0.004322
MOM: Hi PRIOR	0.005453

Question 3

(a)

The investor solves

$$\max_{\varpi_t} E_t[U(W_{t+1})] \quad \text{s.t.} \quad W_{t+1} = W_t\big(R_{f,t+1} + \varpi_t' x R_{t+1}\big).$$

Assume that $W_t > 0$, $W_{t+1} > 0$ almost surely, and that the optimal portfolio choice is interior. Under the usual regularity conditions, we can derive the first-order condition by differentiating expected utility w.r.t. ϖ_t.

This problem can be written as

$$\max_{\varpi_t} E_t\big[U\big(W_t\big(R_{f,t+1} + \varpi_t' x R_{t+1}\big)\big)\big].$$

$$\frac{\partial E_t\big[U\big(W_t\big(R_{f,t+1} + \varpi_t' x R_{t+1}\big)\big)\big]}{\partial \varpi_t} = U'(W_{t+1}) \cdot W_t \cdot x R_{t+1}.$$

$$U(w) = \frac{w^{1-\gamma}}{1-\gamma}, \qquad U'(w) = w^{-\gamma}.$$

Thus, $U'(W_{t+1}) = W_{t+1}^{-\gamma}$.

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial E_t\big[U\big(W_t\big(R_{f,t+1} + \varpi_t' x R_{t+1}\big)\big)\big]}{\partial \varpi_t} &= E_t\big[U'(W_{t+1}) \cdot W_t\big] \\ &= E_t\Big[W_{t+1}^{-\gamma} \cdot W_t \cdot x R_{t+1}\Big] = 0.\end{aligned}$$

$$E_t\left[\frac{W_t}{W_{t+1}^{\gamma}} x R_{t+1}\right] = W_t E_t\left[\frac{1}{W_{t+1}^{\gamma}} x R_{t+1}\right] = 0.$$

Since $W_{t+1}^{\gamma} = (W_t \cdot R_{w,t+1})^{\gamma}$,

$$E_t\left[\frac{1}{(W_t \cdot R_{w,t+1})^{\gamma}} x R_{t+1}\right] = W_t^{-\gamma} E_t\Big[R_{w,t+1}^{-\gamma} x R_{t+1}\Big] = 0.$$

Since $W_t > 0$, we have

$$E_t\Big[R_{w,t+1}^{-\gamma} x R_{t+1}\Big] = 0.$$

(b)

Table 7: GMM estimates using the supplied equity/risk-free log returns, December 1927 through December 2021. Values are rounded to four decimal places.

Statistic	Value
Risk aversion $\hat{\gamma}$	1.9061
Standard error $SE(\hat{\gamma})$	0.6026
Jacobian $\hat{G}$	-0.0480
Long-run variance $\hat{S}$	0.9439
Sample moment $\bar{g}_T(\hat{\gamma})$	0.0000
Observations T	1129
HAC lag L	26

(c)

Using the identity weighting matrix, the GMM estimate of the relative risk aversion coefficient is $\hat{\gamma} = 3.0064$, with a Newey–West standard error of 0.7207. The instrument denominator is the variance of gross equity returns over the 973 estimation observations from December 1940 through December 2021.

The estimated pricing errors for the equity portfolio and the managed portfolio are -0.0038 and 0.0019, respectively. Neither is statistically significant.

The joint $\chi^2(1)$ test yields a p-value of 0.4276, so we fail to reject the null hypothesis that both SDF pricing conditions hold simultaneously at conventional significance levels. This suggests that the data do not provide sufficient evidence to reject the pricing restrictions implied by the power-utility SDF model.

Table 8: Identity-weighting two-moment GMM estimates, December 1940 through December 2021. Results are rounded to four decimal places.

Statistic	Value
Risk aversion $\hat{\gamma}$	3.0064
Standard error $SE(\hat{\gamma})$	0.7207
Pricing error $\bar{g}_1$	-0.0038
t-statistic for $\bar{g}_1$	-0.7934
Pricing error $\bar{g}_2$	0.0019
t-statistic for $\bar{g}_2$	0.7934
Joint Wald χ^2 statistic	0.6294
Joint-test p-value ($df = 1$)	0.4276
Observations T	973
Common HAC lag L	24

(d)

For the two-step GMM estimation, I use the inverse of the Newey–West covariance matrix estimated in Q3(c) as the weighting matrix. The resulting estimate of risk aversion is $\hat{\gamma}_2 = 2.9508$, with a standard error of 0.7106, compared with the first-step estimate of 3.0064.

The estimated pricing errors for the equity portfolio and the managed portfolio are -0.0020 and 0.0055, respectively. Neither is statistically significant. The joint $\chi^2(1)$ test yields a p-value of 0.4192, so we fail to reject the null hypothesis that both pricing errors are jointly zero at conventional significance levels.

Table 9: Two-step efficient GMM, December 1940 through December 2021. Results are rounded to four decimal places.

Statistic	Value
Risk aversion $\hat{\gamma}_2$	2.9508
Standard error $SE(\hat{\gamma}_2)$	0.7106
Pricing error $\bar{g}_1(\hat{\gamma}_2)$	-0.0020
t-statistic for $\bar{g}_1$	-0.8078
Pricing error $\bar{g}_2(\hat{\gamma}_2)$	0.0055
t-statistic for $\bar{g}_2$	0.8078
Joint Wald χ^2 statistic	0.6525
Joint-test p-value ($df = 1$)	0.4192
Observations T	973
First-step HAC lag L_1	24
Second-step HAC lag L_2	24
First-step risk aversion $\hat{\gamma}_1$	3.0064

(e)

Table 10 reports the identity-weighted GMM estimation results using the equity portfolio and 20 book-to-market (BM) and momentum (MOM) decile portfolios.

To ensure consistency with the annual real returns in the EQ Dataset, I compound the monthly nominal returns of the BM and MOM portfolios and the risk-free rate over 12 months, calculate the annual nominal excess returns, and then deflate them using the corresponding 12-month CPI inflation factor. The sample covers December 1927 through December 2021.

Several individual pricing errors are statistically significant, particularly among the momentum portfolios, suggesting that the power-utility SDF does not price all portfolios equally well.

The joint $\chi^2(20)$ test yields a p-value of 0.0000, so we reject the null hypothesis that all 21 pricing errors are jointly zero at conventional significance levels.

Table 10: Identity-weighting GMM with 21 moments. Annual real returns observed monthly, December 1927 through December 2021. Results are rounded to four decimal places. BM and MOM numbers denote deciles from low to high.

Statistic		Value
Risk aversion $\hat{\gamma}$		1.9314
Standard error $SE(\hat{\gamma})$		0.6093
Joint Wald $\chi^2(20)$ statistic		202.9263
Joint-test p-value		0.0000
Observations T		1129
Common HAC lag L		26
Portfolio	**Pricing error**	***t*-statistic**
Equity	-0.0012	-0.3150
BM1	-0.0079	-0.7976
BM2	0.0108	1.5213
BM3	0.0031	0.5205
BM4	-0.0022	-0.3897
BM5	0.0076	1.0870
BM6	0.0135	1.6334
BM7	-0.0021	-0.2321
BM8	0.0208	2.6781
BM9	0.0317	3.4069
BM10	0.0175	1.2359
MOM1	-0.0984	-7.9325
MOM2	-0.0426	-5.1481
MOM3	-0.0299	-3.1821
MOM4	-0.0119	-1.6900
MOM5	-0.0009	-0.1448
MOM6	-0.0004	-0.0863
MOM7	0.0109	1.5880
MOM8	0.0242	4.3724
MOM9	0.0295	3.7306
MOM10	0.0611	4.7192

Additional check: common estimation sample

I noticed that the estimated risk-aversion coefficient $\hat{\gamma}$ varies considerably across Q3(b)–Q3(e). In Q3(b) and Q3(e), the estimates are 1.9061 and 1.9314, respectively, while Q3(c) and Q3(d) produce higher estimates of 3.0064 and 2.9508. One possible explanation is the difference in estimation periods: Q3(b) and Q3(e) use December 1927 through December 2021, whereas Q3(c) and Q3(d) use December 1940 through December 2021.

To investigate this, I re-estimate Q3(b) and Q3(e) using the restricted sample from December 1940 through December 2021, keeping their original moment conditions, weighting matrices, and estimation methods unchanged. Table 11 reports the comparison.

After restricting the sample, the estimated $\hat{\gamma}$ increases from 1.9061 to 2.8878 for Q3(b), and from 1.9314 to 3.0359 for Q3(e). The estimates across all four specifications are now much closer, ranging from 2.8878 to 3.0359. This suggests that differences in the estimation periods account for a substantial part of the variation in $\hat{\gamma}$, while the remaining differences may reflect the different moment conditions and GMM weighting matrices.

Table 11: Additional sample comparison for Question 3. Original samples run from December 1927 through December 2021; restricted samples and existing Q3(c)/(d) results use December 1940 through December 2021. Estimates and standard errors are rounded to four decimal places.

Model	Sample	Moments	Weight	T	L	$\hat{\gamma}$	SE
Q3(b)	Original	1	I	1129	26	1.9061	0.6026
Q3(b)	Restricted	1	I	973	24	2.8878	0.7086
Q3(c)	Existing	2	I	973	24	3.0064	0.7207
Q3(d)	Existing	2	$\hat{S}_1^{-1}$	973	24	2.9508	0.7106
Q3(e)	Original	21	I	1129	26	1.9314	0.6093
Q3(e)	Restricted	21	I	973	24	3.0359	0.7088

Only Q3(b) and Q3(e) are re-estimated on the restricted sample. Their original moment conditions, return construction, identity weights, optimization methods, and HAC rules are retained. Annual returns are constructed before restricting dates; HAC lags are selected anew on the restricted moments. Q3(c) and Q3(d) are copied from their saved results; the Q3(d) lag shown is the second-step lag. I denotes the identity matrix of the appropriate dimension. All original results are retained.

Question 4

(a)

By applying a first-order Taylor approximation, we have

$$\begin{aligned} M_{t+1} &= f(F_{t+1}, \theta) \\ &\approx f(E_t[F], \theta) + \partial_F f(E_t[F], \theta)'\big(F_{t+1} - E_t[F]\big) \equiv M_{t+1}^{\text{linear}}. \end{aligned}$$

Since $M_{t+1} = R_{w,t+1}^{-\gamma}$,

$$F_{t+1} = R_{w,t+1}, \qquad \theta = \gamma, \qquad f(F, \gamma) = F^{-\gamma}.$$

Substituting the actual form, we have

$$\begin{aligned} f\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}], \gamma\big) &= \big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma}, \\ f'\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}], \gamma\big) &= -\gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1}. \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} M_{t+1} = R_{w,t+1}^{-\gamma} &\approx \big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} - \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1}\big(R_{w,t+1} - E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big) \\ &= \big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} - \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1} R_{w,t+1} + \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} \\ &= (1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} - \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1} R_{w,t+1}. \end{aligned}$$

$$a_t = (1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma}, \qquad b_t = \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1}.$$

Thus,

$$M_{t+1} \approx a_t - b_t R_{w,t+1}, \qquad a_t = (1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma}, \qquad b_t = \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1}.$$

For $\gamma > 0$, $a_t - b_t R_{w,t+1} < 0$ if

$$\begin{aligned} (1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} - \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1} R_{w,t+1} &< 0, \\ (1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma} &< \gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1} R_{w,t+1}, \\ R_{w,t+1} &> \frac{(1+\gamma)\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma}}{\gamma\big(E_t[R_{w,t+1}]\big)^{-\gamma-1}} = \frac{1+\gamma}{\gamma} E_t[R_{w,t+1}]. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the linear SDF is not guaranteed to remain positive, unlike the original nonlinear SDF. This is a disadvantage because strict positivity of an SDF is sufficient to ensure no-arbitrage pricing. The linear approximation does not necessarily preserve this property.

(b)

Table 12: Identity-weighting GMM for the normalized linear SDF, December 1927 through December 2021. Results are rounded to four decimal places; standard errors account for estimation of the mean wealth return. BM and MOM numbers denote deciles from low to high.

Statistic		Value
SDF slope $\hat{b}$		1.9356
Standard error $SE(\hat{b})$		0.6425
Joint Wald $\chi^2(20)$ statistic		231.3234
Joint-test p-value		0.0000
Observations T		1129
Common HAC lag L		26
Portfolio	Pricing error	t-statistic
Equity	0.0025	0.5249
BM1	-0.0041	-0.3663
BM2	0.0168	2.0332
BM3	0.0064	0.9379
BM4	-0.0023	-0.3875
BM5	0.0101	1.4719
BM6	0.0149	1.9235
BM7	-0.0027	-0.2914
BM8	0.0178	2.1771
BM9	0.0252	2.5033
BM10	0.0069	0.4700
MOM1	-0.1076	-8.8135
MOM2	-0.0484	-5.5359
MOM3	-0.0275	-2.8888
MOM4	-0.0131	-1.8467
MOM5	0.0005	0.0673
MOM6	0.0002	0.0337
MOM7	0.0163	2.2130
MOM8	0.0291	4.5403
MOM9	0.0356	3.9909
MOM10	0.0704	5.0555

The estimation uses 1,129 monthly observations of annual real returns, from December 1927 through December 2021. The return construction and ending-month alignment are identical to Question 3(e). The sample mean wealth return is $\bar{R}_w = 1.087734$. The fitted SDF is $\hat{M}_t = 1 - 1.935628(R_{w,t} - \bar{R}_w)$, equivalently $\hat{M}_t = 3.105449 - 1.935628R_{w,t}$; its unrounded sample mean is 1.

The coefficient is calculated analytically with the identity weighting matrix. HAC estimation uses the specified adjusted series $\tilde{g}_t = g_t(\hat{b}) + \hat{b}\hat{\mu}(R_{w,t} - \bar{R}_w)$ to account for estimation of $\bar{R}_w$. The common lag is selected from the sum of all 21 centered adjusted series. The pilot is $m = 7$, the NW94 constant is $C = 2.4458$, and $L = \lceil CT^{1/3} \rceil = \lceil 25.4678 \rceil = 26$. Bartlett autocovariances use divisor $T - \ell$. The full HAC matrix is saved in `results/q4b_hac_matrix.csv`. Pricing-error tests account for estimation of both b and $E[R_w]$; the joint test uses 20 degrees of freedom. The unrounded joint-test p-value is approximately 6.495×10^{-38}.

For reconstructed annual real RF minus e^{rf_t}, the mean signed difference is -0.000003, the mean absolute difference is 0.000012, the RMSE is 0.000037, and the maximum absolute difference is 0.000203. Their correlation is 0.999999520. No identity of the risk-free benchmarks or inflation deflators is assumed.

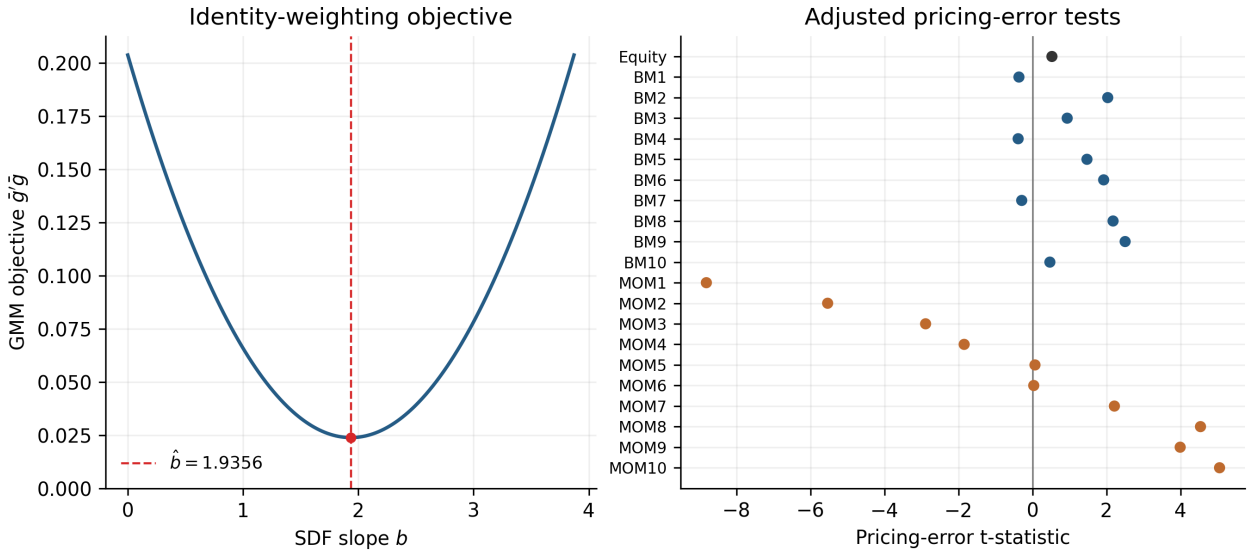


Figure 4: The identity-weighting GMM objective for the normalized linear SDF and pricing-error t-statistics adjusted for estimation of both b and the mean wealth return. The dashed line marks the analytical estimate.